

DM-2026-013

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TO: PSI Team, Payload Developers, Submitting Organizations, NASA JSC CUI Program Manager

SUBJECT: Marking Guidance: Export Classification on a completed Software Product Form

OFFICE OF PRIMARY RESPONSIBILITY: Payload Software Integration (PSI)

1. **Purpose**

2. This memorandum gives a payload developer a rule for filling the **Export Classification** and **Export Statement** fields on a Software Product Form (SPF), and says who adjudicates when the answer is not obvious. It is prompted by a concrete case: how a developer should mark an SPF for a secure shell (SSH) implementation delivered with a payload.

3. **Background**

4. SSP 57061, Paragraph 6.1.4, requires a Test SPF and a Flight SPF for a payload software update, alongside a Version Description Document and malware scan evidence. SPFs are entered in the ORBIT Software Products (SWP) application.
5. The SPF carries an Export Classification field and an Export Statement field. The field definitions note that the Payload Software Integration Engineer (PSIE) may enter them. Neither the field definitions nor the application states *when* a product raises a classification, or what a submitter should weigh. Both fields default to an unset value, and an unset value is indistinguishable from a considered answer of “none”.
6. Security-relevant products are precisely the products most likely to appear on an SPF and most likely to matter here. SSH is one: SSP 57000 Appendix I and SSP 57003 Appendix L each give SSH Key Delivery and SSH Configuration their own requirement clauses, alongside Encrypted Protocols. Antivirus software and operating systems are others.

7. **Analysis**

8. **Neither fact is sensitive alone.** A commercial software version is published by its vendor. The existence of an ISS payload is public. A submitter reasoning about either in isolation will correctly conclude that nothing needs marking.

9. **The form binds them, and the binding is a different fact.** A completed SPF states that a *named* on-orbit system is running a *specific* version of a security-relevant product. That is a statement about which published weaknesses that system carries, which is not derivable from either half.
10. **The programme has already taken this view once.** DM-2026-008 treats antivirus distribution specifics as controlled for the same reason: the sensitivity is created by associating security software with the systems it protects, not by the software's identity. A payload-bound SSH version is the same shape of fact.
11. **This does not disturb DM-2026-007 or DM-2026-012.** Those determinations concern blank forms and field definitions — material that shows *which fields exist* without populating them. That reasoning is unaffected and is reaffirmed here. What changes at the point of population is the aggregation, not the form.
12. **Over-marking has a cost too.** If every SPF is marked, marking stops carrying information and the fields become noise. The rule below is therefore scoped to security-relevant products rather than applied to all.
13. **Decision**
14. A submitter **shall not leave Export Classification unset** on a submitted SPF. An unset value is not a determination.
15. Where the product is **security-relevant** — including but not limited to secure shell implementations, antivirus software, operating systems, and cryptographic libraries — the submitter shall **refer the marking to the PSIE** rather than self-determine, and shall treat the completed form as potentially controlled until the PSIE responds.
16. Where the product is **not security-relevant**, the submitter may enter the classification directly, and should record the basis in the Export Statement field rather than leaving it empty.
17. Questions that the PSIE cannot resolve shall be referred to the NASA JSC CUI Program Manager, following the route DM-2026-008 established.
18. **Implementation**
19. Payload developer training material shall state that Export Classification is a required judgement rather than an optional field, and shall use SSH as the worked example, since it is the case where the Software Product Form and the IT security requirements meet.
20. PSI recommends that the SWP field definitions carry a short paragraph under Export Classification stating that the classification of a form is not the classification of the product,

because the form binds the product to a payload. That recommendation is raised separately against the next revision of those definitions.

21. Conditions that change this guidance

22. A determination by the NASA JSC CUI Program Manager that payload-bound software version information is, or is not, controlled — which would replace the referral rule above with a direct answer.

23. A change to the SWP application that removes the unset default, or that adds its own marking guidance.

24. Any change to DM-2026-008's treatment of security software associated with the systems it protects.

25. References

26. SSP 57061, Standard Payload Integration Agreement for ISS Payloads, Paragraph 6.1.4, Software Updates.

27. SSP 57000 Appendix I and SSP 57003 Appendix L, Information Technology System Security.

28. ORBIT SWP field definitions, Software Product Form.

29. DM-2026-007, blank form CUI determination; DM-2026-008, desk instruction CUI classification; DM-2026-012, training package CUI determination.